

25 Standard Operating Procedure generators

25
PROMPTS

PDF
FORMAT

4 AI
COMPATIBLE

\$19
USD

Operations

Works with: **ChatGPT • Claude • Gemini • Llama**

About This Playbook

25 prompts that generate complete, formatted SOPs for every business department. Each prompt creates a comprehensive procedure with steps, responsibilities, and metrics.

What You'll Get

- 25 expert prompts
- Professional-grade frameworks
- Placeholder system for instant use
- Expert tips on every prompt

Who It's For

- Entrepreneurs
- Professionals
- Consultants
- Teams

How to Use This Playbook

- 1 Copy the prompt — Select the full prompt text from the section that matches your goal.
- 2 Fill in the brackets — Replace all [PLACEHOLDER] text with your specific context, brand, or product.
- 3 Paste & generate — Paste into ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or your preferred AI tool.
- 4 Iterate — Use the output as a starting point. Refine with follow-up prompts for best results.

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Section 1

HR & People Operations (5 prompts)

Prompt #01

Employee Onboarding SOP

Write a complete employee onboarding SOP for [COMPANY] for the first 90

You are an HR operations specialist. Write a complete employee onboarding SOP for [COMPANY] for the first 90 days. Deliver: Day 1 (Admin + Welcome): IT setup checklist, team introductions, welcome package Week 1 (Orientation): Company history, mission, culture, key systems training Month 1 (Ramp): Job-specific training, first 30-day goals, buddy assignment Days 31-90 (Integration): Performance check-ins, project ownership, cultural integration Responsible party for each step + escalation path

Placeholders: [COMPANY] Your company name

■ **Tip:** The onboarding SOP is your culture in action. Great onboarding reduces time-to-productivity by 50% and increases 1-year retention.

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Prompt #02

Performance Review SOP

Write a complete performance review SOP for [COMPANY] including templa

You are an HR performance management expert. Write a complete performance review SOP for [COMPANY] including templates and scoring. Deliver: 1. Review cycle: Frequency + timeline + participants 2. Self-review template: 5 questions employees answer 3. Manager review template: 5 dimensions with 1-5 scoring rubric 4. 360 feedback process: Who provides, how it's collected 5. Calibration meeting: How managers align on ratings 6. Delivery conversation guide: How to give feedback well 7. Development plan template: 90-day goals post-review

Placeholders: [COMPANY] Your company

■ **Tip:** Performance reviews fail when they're surprises. Any feedback in a review should have been given in real-time first.

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Prompt #03

Recruitment and Hiring SOP

Write a complete recruitment SOP for [COMPANY] from job post to offer

You are a talent acquisition specialist. Write a complete recruitment SOP for [COMPANY] from job post to offer letter. Deliver: Stage 1 – Job definition: Role scorecard creation, compensation benchmarking Stage 2 – Sourcing: Job posting, sourcing channels, recruiter workflow Stage 3 – Screening: Resume review criteria, phone screen template Stage 4 – Interviews: Panel structure, question bank, scoring rubric Stage 5 – Decision: Calibration process, offer approval chain Stage 6 – Offer: Verbal offer script, written offer template, close process Stage 7 – Pre-boarding: Docusign workflow, day 1 prep

Placeholders: [COMPANY] Your company

■ **Tip:** Time to hire is your competitive advantage in talent acquisition. Map your SOP to cut the average from 45 days to 21.

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Prompt #04

Employee Exit SOP

Write a complete employee offboarding SOP for voluntary and involuntary

You are an HR compliance specialist. Write a complete employee offboarding SOP for voluntary and involuntary departures. Deliver: For both types: 1. IT security: Access revocation checklist (email, Slack, systems, AWS) 2. Knowledge transfer: Handoff documentation, project status update 3. Equipment return: Hardware return process 4. Legal: Final paycheck, benefits termination, NDA reminder 5. Communication: Internal announcement template, client notification 6. Exit interview: Questions to ask, how to use the data Involuntary additions: HR script, witness policy, severance documentation

■ **Tip:** The exit experience shapes the story your former employees tell about you. A well-run exit creates brand ambassadors.

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Prompt #05

Remote Work Policy SOP

Write a remote work policy and SOP for [COMPANY].

You are a distributed team operations expert. Write a remote work policy and SOP for [COMPANY]. Deliver: Core policy areas: 1. Eligibility and approval process 2. Core hours and availability expectations 3. Equipment: What company provides vs employee provides 4. Home office stipend (if any) + setup requirements 5. Communication norms (response time, camera policy, meeting attendance) 6. Performance measurement for remote employees 7. Security requirements (VPN, password manager, storage) 8. Travel and in-person gathering policy + Remote-specific manager guide

Placeholders: [COMPANY] Your company

■ **Tip:** Remote work fails without explicit norms. Document everything — especially the unspoken expectations that kill trust when violated.

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Section 2

Finance & Accounting (5 prompts)

Prompt #06

Invoice and Payment Processing SOP

Write an invoice processing and accounts payable SOP for [COMPANY].

You are a finance operations specialist. Write an invoice processing and accounts payable SOP for [COMPANY]. Deliver: Accounts Receivable (Outgoing invoices): 1. Invoice creation: Template, required fields, numbering system 2. Send process: When to send, to whom, via what system 3. Payment follow-up: Day 30/45/60 escalation sequence 4. Dispute resolution: How to handle invoice disputes Accounts Payable (Incoming invoices): 1. Invoice receipt: Email, routing, approval workflow 2. Approval thresholds: Who approves what dollar amount 3. Payment schedule: When payments are processed 4. Vendor management: Onboarding, payment terms, 1099 tracking

Placeholders: [COMPANY] Your company

■ **Tip:** Clear AP/AR SOPs reduce cash flow uncertainty by 30%. Late payment is usually a process failure, not an intentional choice.

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Prompt #07

Expense Reporting SOP

Write an employee expense reporting SOP for [COMPANY] with policy and

You are a finance compliance specialist. Write an employee expense reporting SOP for [COMPANY] with policy and approval workflow. Deliver: 1. What's reimbursable (categories with dollar thresholds) 2. What requires pre-approval (amount threshold + category) 3. Receipt requirements (digital, original, description) 4. Submission process (tool, deadline, format) 5. Approval workflow (manager + finance + CEO for above \$X) 6. Reimbursement timeline (when employees get paid back) 7. Violations and consequences + Expense report template

Placeholders: [COMPANY] Your company

■ **Tip:** Unclear expense policies create resentment. Employees who feel policed spend more, not less. Clear generous policies with hard limits work better.

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Prompt #08

Financial Close SOP — Monthly

Write a monthly financial close SOP for [COMPANY] with a complete clos

You are a financial controller. Write a monthly financial close SOP for [COMPANY] with a complete close checklist. Deliver: Week 1 (Days 1-5 of month): • All invoices entered for prior month • Bank reconciliation complete • Payroll verified and posted Week 2 (Days 6-10): • Revenue recognition complete • Deferred revenue schedule updated • COGS accruals posted Close Day (Day 10-15): • P&L review and variance analysis • Balance sheet review • Management reporting package ready Deadlines + responsible party for each step

Placeholders: [COMPANY] Your company

■ **Tip:** A 10-day close is achievable for companies under \$10M ARR. A 20-day close means you're making decisions with 3-week-old data.

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Prompt #09

Budget Process SOP

Write an annual budget planning SOP for [COMPANY] from kick-off to board approval.

You are a FP&A specialist. Write an annual budget planning SOP for [COMPANY] from kick-off to board approval. Deliver: Month 1 (September): Strategic planning • CEO/leadership set priorities • Bottoms-up inputs from department heads Month 2 (October): Build • Finance consolidates inputs • Scenario modeling (conservative/base/optimistic) • First draft review with CEO Month 3 (November): Finalize • Department head approval • Board package preparation • Board review and approval + Budget template structure + variance reporting cadence

Placeholders: [COMPANY] Your company

■ **Tip:** The budget is not a target — it's a hypothesis. Build in monthly variance reviews to update your plan as reality changes.

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Prompt #10

Vendor Evaluation and Procurement SOP

Write a vendor evaluation and procurement SOP for [COMPANY] for contracts above [THRESHOLD].

You are a procurement specialist. Write a vendor evaluation and procurement SOP for [COMPANY] for contracts above [THRESHOLD]. Deliver: 1. Needs definition: What problem we're solving + requirements document 2. RFP process: How to write and issue a request for proposal 3. Vendor shortlist: How many to evaluate, scoring matrix 4. Evaluation criteria: Weighted scorecard (price, capabilities, references, terms) 5. Reference check: 3 questions to ask every reference 6. Negotiation: Standard terms to push for, red lines 7. Approval: Who signs off at what contract value 8. Contract management: Where it lives, renewal tracking

Placeholders: [COMPANY] Your company [THRESHOLD] Contract value threshold (e.g. \$5,000)

■ **Tip:** Procurement SOPs save 15-25% on vendor spend through better negotiation leverage and competitive evaluation.

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Section 3

Marketing & Content (5 prompts)

Prompt #11

Content Publishing SOP

Write a content publishing SOP for [BRAND]'s blog and social media.

You are a content operations manager. Write a content publishing SOP for [BRAND]'s blog and social media. Deliver: Blog SOP: 1. Ideation: Keyword research → content calendar → brief creation 2. Writing: Brief format, word count guidelines, SEO requirements 3. Review: Editor checklist, approval by marketing lead 4. Optimization: SEO meta, featured image, internal links 5. Publishing: CMS workflow, URL structure, distribution steps Social SOP: 1. Content calendar management 2. Asset creation standards (image sizes, caption format) 3. Scheduling: Tool, timing guidelines per platform 4. Engagement: Response time standards, who monitors what

Placeholders: [BRAND] Your brand

■ **Tip:** Content without a publishing SOP is content chaos. A documented workflow cuts production time by 40% and improves consistency.

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Prompt #12

Social Media Crisis Response SOP

Write a social media crisis response SOP for [BRAND].

You are a social media crisis management specialist. Write a social media crisis response SOP for [BRAND]. Deliver: Crisis levels: Level 1 – Complaint: Individual negative comment. Response time: 4 hours. Level 2 – Pile-on: Multiple negative comments on one post. Response time: 2 hours. Level 3 – Viral Negative: Trending negative mention. Response time: 1 hour. Level 4 – Reputation Crisis: Mainstream media + viral. Response time: 30 minutes. For each level: • Who is notified (roles) • Who responds (social, PR, legal, CEO) • Response template framework • Escalation trigger to next level • When to issue public statement • Post-crisis review process

Placeholders: [BRAND] Your brand

■ **Tip:** Speed is your biggest asset in a social media crisis. A slow, perfect response loses to a fast, honest one every time.

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Prompt #13

Email Marketing SOP

Write an email marketing SOP for [BRAND] covering campaign production

You are an email marketing operations specialist. Write an email marketing SOP for [BRAND] covering campaign production and deployment. Deliver: Campaign creation: 1. Brief: Goal, audience segment, key message, CTA 2. Copywriting: Template, review, legal check 3. Design: Email build, mobile preview, dark mode test 4. QA: Spam score check, link test, rendering test across 5 email clients 5. Approval: Marketing lead + legal for regulated content Deployment: 1. Audience segmentation and list pull 2. A/B test setup (if applicable) 3. Timing optimization by segment 4. Deployment and monitoring (opens, clicks, bounces, unsubscribes in first 2 hours)

Placeholders: [BRAND] Your brand

■ **Tip:** Email QA is boring and prevents disasters. A broken link in a send to 50,000 subscribers is an embarrassing, irreversible mistake.

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Prompt #14

Ad Campaign Management SOP

Write a paid advertising campaign management SOP for [COMPANY] across

You are a paid media operations manager. Write a paid advertising campaign management SOP for [COMPANY] across [PLATFORMS]. Deliver: Launch checklist: 1. Brief approval: Goal, budget, audience, creative, CTA 2. Tracking: Pixel verification, conversion event setup, UTM parameters 3. Creative: Approved assets uploaded, copy approved 4. Campaign structure: Campaign/ad set/ad hierarchy documented 5. Bid strategy: Aligned to objective Optimization cadence: • Daily: Check spend pace, flag anomalies • Weekly: Performance review, A/B test decisions • Monthly: Strategic review, budget reallocation, creative refresh Handoff and documentation: How to transfer campaign management

Placeholders: [COMPANY] Your company [PLATFORMS] e.g. Google, Meta, LinkedIn

■ **Tip:** UTM parameters are not optional. If you can't attribute revenue to specific campaigns, you can't optimize spend.

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Prompt #15

SEO Content Workflow SOP

Write an SEO content production SOP for [WEBSITE] to rank for [TARGET

You are an SEO content strategist. Write an SEO content production SOP for [WEBSITE] to rank for [TARGET KEYWORDS]. Deliver: 1. Keyword research: Tools, volume thresholds, difficulty targeting 2. Search intent mapping: Informational vs commercial vs transactional 3. Content brief: Template with target keyword, related keywords, headers outline, word count, competitor analysis 4. Writing standards: EAT requirements, heading structure, link requirements 5. On-page optimization: Title tag, meta description, alt text, internal links 6. Publishing: URL format, schema markup, submission to GSC 7. Tracking: Position tracking setup, content performance review at 30/90/180 days

Placeholders: [WEBSITE] Your website [TARGET KEYWORDS] Your focus keywords

■ **Tip:** Content without a brief produces content that doesn't rank. Brief every piece — even if you're writing it yourself.

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Section 4

Customer Service (5 prompts)

Prompt #16

Customer Complaint Handling SOP

Write a customer complaint handling SOP for [COMPANY] covering all cha

You are a customer experience specialist. Write a customer complaint handling SOP for [COMPANY] covering all channels. Deliver: Channels: Email, phone, live chat, social media, review sites For each channel: 1. First response time SLA (by severity) 2. Response template (acknowledge + apologize + action + close) 3. Escalation triggers (what requires manager involvement) 4. Resolution authority (what frontline can resolve vs needs approval) 5. Documentation: How complaints are logged and categorized Weekly complaint review: • Top complaint categories → root cause → product/process improvement

Placeholders: [COMPANY] Your company

■ **Tip:** Every complaint is product feedback. Companies that track and act on complaint patterns reduce volume by 30% year-over-year.

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Prompt #17

Customer Onboarding SOP

Write a customer onboarding SOP for [B2B PRODUCT] to achieve activation

You are a customer success manager. Write a customer onboarding SOP for [B2B PRODUCT] to achieve activation within [TIMEFRAME]. Deliver: Phase 1 – Kickoff (Day 1): • Kickoff call agenda • Success plan template • Technical setup checklist Phase 2 – Implementation (Days 2-14): • Training schedule • Integration setup guide • First value milestone definition Phase 3 – Activation (Days 15-30): • Adoption metrics review • Check-in call cadence • Expansion opportunity identification + Health score calculation for each phase

Placeholders: [B2B PRODUCT] Your product [TIMEFRAME] e.g. 30 days

■ **Tip:** Onboarding is the most important part of the customer journey. The #1 predictor of churn is poor activation in month 1.

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Prompt #18

Returns and Refunds SOP

Write a returns and refunds SOP for [BUSINESS] to balance customer sat

You are an e-commerce operations specialist. Write a returns and refunds SOP for [BUSINESS] to balance customer satisfaction and margins. Deliver: Return request process: 1. Customer submits return request (form/email/chat) 2. Eligibility check (within policy window, condition requirements) 3. Approval and return label generation 4. Item receipt and inspection 5. Refund processing (timeline, method, amount) 6. Exception handling (outside policy, but goodwill exception) Metrics to track: • Return rate by product/category • Return reason codes • Refund as % of revenue • Cost per return

Placeholders: [BUSINESS] Your business

■ **Tip:** Returns are expensive to process but cheap to prevent. Monthly return reason analysis is your best product improvement input.

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Prompt #19

Support Ticket Management SOP

Write a support ticket management SOP for [COMPANY] using [TOOL] as th

You are a customer support operations manager. Write a support ticket management SOP for [COMPANY] using [TOOL] as the helpdesk. Deliver: Ticket intake: • Channel routing (email, chat, phone, social → unified queue) • Auto-classification rules (type, priority, product area) • SLA assignment (response + resolution time by priority) Ticket workflow: • Triage: Assignment and priority verification • First response: Template selection + personalization • Resolution: Knowledge base lookup → escalation if needed • Closure: Resolution confirmation + CSAT survey Quality assurance: • Weekly ticket review (5 random tickets per agent) • CSAT target and improvement protocol

Placeholders: [COMPANY] Your company [TOOL] Your helpdesk tool (Zendesk/Freshdesk/Intercom)

■ **Tip:** First contact resolution rate is the metric that matters most in support. Measure it, then engineer your SOPs to maximize it.

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Prompt #20

Escalation and Crisis Response SOP

Write a customer escalation and crisis response SOP for [COMPANY].

You are a customer operations director. Write a customer escalation and crisis response SOP for [COMPANY]. Deliver: Escalation levels: Level 1 – Standard escalation: Frontline cannot resolve → senior agent → 30 min Level 2 – Management escalation: Senior cannot resolve → manager → 2 hours Level 3 – Executive escalation: Threat of churn/legal/media → exec → 4 hours Level 4 – Crisis: Multiple affected customers/system down → war room → 1 hour For each level: • Trigger criteria • Who is notified (roles + contact info) • Response template • Resolution authority • Communication to affected customers

Placeholders: [COMPANY] Your company

■ **Tip:** Escalations are your most expensive support interactions. Track root causes — 80% of escalations come from 20% of issue types.

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Section 5

IT & Security (5 prompts)

Prompt #21

Security Incident Response SOP

Write a security incident response SOP for [COMPANY] aligned with NIST

You are a cybersecurity operations specialist. Write a security incident response SOP for [COMPANY] aligned with NIST framework. Deliver: Incident severity levels: P1 (Critical): Active breach, data exfiltration, ransomware P2 (High): Failed intrusion attempt, credential compromise P3 (Medium): Policy violation, phishing attempt P4 (Low): Suspicious activity, failed login anomaly For each severity: 1. Detection and identification 2. Containment (immediate and long-term) 3. Eradication 4. Recovery 5. Post-incident review (within 48 hours) + Communication templates: Internal, customer, regulator

Placeholders: [COMPANY] Your company

■ **Tip:** The first 15 minutes of a security incident determine the outcome. Every second spent figuring out who does what is a second the attacker uses.

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Prompt #22

Software Development and Deployment SOP

Write a software development and deployment SOP for [ENGINEERING TEAM]

You are a DevOps engineer. Write a software development and deployment SOP for [ENGINEERING TEAM]. Deliver: Development workflow: 1. Ticket creation and definition of done 2. Branch naming convention 3. Code review requirements (who reviews, what they check) 4. Testing requirements (unit, integration, QA) 5. PR approval and merge policy Deployment pipeline: 1. Staging deployment and testing 2. Production deployment window and process 3. Feature flag usage for risky changes 4. Rollback procedure (< 5 minutes) 5. Post-deployment monitoring (30 minutes, then 24 hours) Incident during deployment: Who decides to roll back and how

Placeholders: [ENGINEERING TEAM] Your team

■ **Tip:** A deployment SOP that includes a rollback procedure enables fearless shipping. Without it, every deploy is a moment of anxiety.

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Prompt #23

Data Backup and Recovery SOP

Write a data backup and recovery SOP for [COMPANY] with RPO and RTO targets

You are an IT infrastructure specialist. Write a data backup and recovery SOP for [COMPANY] with RPO and RTO targets. Deliver: Backup policy: • What data is backed up (classify: critical/important/archival) • Backup frequency by data tier (hourly/daily/weekly/monthly) • Retention period by tier • Backup location (on-site, off-site, cloud) • Encryption requirements Recovery procedures: • Recovery time objective (RTO) target by data tier • Recovery point objective (RPO) target by data tier • Recovery runbook (step-by-step for each scenario) • Test schedule (quarterly recovery test with documentation) Disaster recovery plan: Full site failure scenario

Placeholders: [COMPANY] Your company

■ **Tip:** An untested backup is not a backup. Schedule quarterly recovery tests and document every one — regulators and insurers require evidence.

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Prompt #24

Access Control and Offboarding SOP

Write an access control management SOP for [COMPANY] covering provisioning and deprovisioning

You are an IT security specialist. Write an access control management SOP for [COMPANY] covering provisioning and deprovisioning. Deliver: New employee provisioning: • Day 1 access checklist by role • Approval workflow for non-standard access • MFA requirement policy • Password manager onboarding Employee offboarding (most critical): • Immediate actions on last day (minute-by-minute) • Email, Slack, GitHub, AWS, Salesforce, all SaaS tools • Shared credentials rotation • Data export and personal data removal • 30-day monitoring for post-departure access attempts + Quarterly access review process

Placeholders: [COMPANY] Your company

■ **Tip:** Access deprovisioning failures are the #1 source of insider security incidents. Treat every offboarding like a security event.

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Prompt #25

Vendor Security Assessment SOP

Write a vendor security assessment SOP for [COMPANY] evaluating tools

You are a vendor risk management specialist. Write a vendor security assessment SOP for [COMPANY] evaluating tools that access company data. Deliver: Vendor risk tiers: Tier 1 (Critical): Access to production data → full SOC2 review required Tier 2 (High): Access to internal data → questionnaire + reference check Tier 3 (Medium): No data access → lightweight review For Tier 1 vendors: 1. Security questionnaire (20 key questions) 2. SOC2 report review 3. Penetration test requirements 4. Data processing agreement 5. Annual review schedule Approval workflow: Who can approve Tier 1/2/3 vendors

Placeholders: [COMPANY] Your company

■ **Tip:** Your security is only as good as your weakest vendor. The vendor with the least security holds your most critical data 40% of the time.

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